

Figure 17: The Mandayam Brothers: (left to right): S. Parthasarathy, S. Thirumalachari and S. Srinivasachari; their father Krishnamachari is second from left.

S.D. Krishna Aiyangar and K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar negotiated a loan of Rs 1,50,000 from the brothers. S. Thirumalachari first advanced Rs 50,000 on the promise of a mortgage over a steamer,[21] apart from a full managing agency if he loaned a further Rs 1 lakh.

Though the information about this loan is corroborated by Thirumalachari's brother S. Srinivasachari, the Madurai collector, H.F.W. Gillman, is quite wrong in other details. VOC had encouraged the Mandayam brothers to take shares even before the Surat Congress of 1907.[22] Shortly after VOC's imprisonment, the eldest brother, S. Thirumalachari had borrowed Rs 5,000 and remitted it to S.D. Krishna Aiyangar and K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar. Soon, worried about his investments, he wrote to his two brothers to go to Tuticorin and check the accounts. On looking at the books the Mandayam brothers S. Srinivasachari and S. Parthasarathy were convinced that unless someone with deep pockets took charge of the company there was little hope of turning it around.[23] Since Pandithurai Thevar was a primary investor, they proceeded to Madurai to consult him. Thevar was clear that a patriotic enterprise should